

Pachycephalosaur

This herbivore had a mysterious dome of solid bone at the top of its skull, but what for? One old theory is that males had head-butting contests like rams—but their curved necks might not have been able to take the force. Another theory is that they swung their heavy heads sideways at each other like giraffes. Or perhaps their fancy heads merely served to impress mates and rivals.

Last of the dinosaurs

Pachycephalosaur lived at the end of the Cretaceous Period and was one of the species wiped out in the dinosaurs' mass extinction.



DID YOU KNOW...?

Pachycephalosaur is known only from one complete skull (a replica of which is shown below) and a few skull fragments. The dome of thick bone on its skull was fringed by bony knobs and spikes, which may have been used for display. Its teeth were tiny and its eyes large.

